Infrastructure Comprehensively Defined by the Ministry of Finance

The Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, notified a harmonized master list of infrastructure for the first time in 2006. This has been expanded from time to time. The notification in August 2020 included affordable rental housing complexes in the list. The harmonized list of infrastructure is divided into five subsectors: transport and logistics; energy; water and sanitation; communication; and social and commercial infrastructure. In all, thirty-four specific types of infrastructure are mentioned in the master list. However, it still excludes technological or non-physical infrastructure.

There is a direct relationship between economic growth and infrastructure investment as a country graduates from low income to middle income status. Several ministries and departments in the Government of India deal with different types and aspects of infrastructure. There is no overarching ministry or department responsible for infrastructure. Some coordination in approach has been done by the Planning Commission (now NITI Aayog) and the Ministry of Finance.

Infrastructure Investment Rose Sharply from 2005–06

According to the 2014 version of Infrastructure Statistics, India's investment in infrastructure as well as private-sector investment rose significantly from 2005–06 onwards.

India's investment in infrastructure was barely 4–5 per cent of GDP in the years 1999–2000 and 2005–06. As the GDP itself was small, this translated into infrastructure investment of Rs 1–2 lakh crore per annum during this period. As growth took off, infrastructure investment also rose. Infrastructure investment exceeded 5 per cent of GDP in 2005–06, 6 per cent in 2007–08 and 8 per cent in 2010–11.